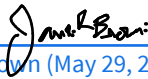


James R. Brown
Jeanne & John R. Blocker Chair in Business Administration
Professor and Department Head

MEMORANDUM

TO: Hwagyun Kim, Associate Professor, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance

FROM: Jamie Brown, Head, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance


Jamie Brown (May 29, 2025 11:19 CDT)

SUBJECT: Annual Performance Review: January 1, 2024 – December 31, 2024

Both Texas A&M University and Mays Business School require that the performance of all faculty be reviewed on an annual basis. As noted in the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines, the purposes of the annual performance review include:

- Creating a sound and logical basis for merit compensation recommendations
- Providing evaluative feedback regarding how well the individual is currently performing
- Providing developmental feedback regarding areas where the faculty member's contribution may be enhanced and/or improved in the future
- Providing feedback regarding progress toward promotion and/or tenure as relevant

Further, the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines define four levels of performance for the key dimensions across which performance is reviewed. These levels of performance are:

- *Excellent performance*: a high level of performance that meets and exceeds norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *excellence*;
- *Effective performance*: performance that meets norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *effective* performance;
- *Needs improvement performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *effective* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *needs improvement* performance;
- *Unsatisfactory performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *excellent*, *effective*, and *needs improvement* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *unsatisfactory* performance.

This letter serves as your performance review for the 2024 calendar year. The following reflects information provided in your Faculty 180 submission. In addition, the tenured Finance faculty had the opportunity to review your annual report (containing detailed information about your research, teaching, and service) and current resume and provided me with their assessment and feedback. In the sections below, I first briefly summarize the main contributions you have made in each area, present the assessment of the tenured faculty, and provide my own independent assessment.

Research

Highlights of your research activity during the three-year evaluation window include:

- In the last three years, you had one publication in the Journal of Corporate Finance.
- You also have a new revise and resubmit at the Review of Economic Studies, a top Economics journal, in addition to three existing papers at the revise and resubmit stage.
- You also have a new “reject and resubmit” at a top Finance journal.

Teaching

- You taught one section of FINC 428/660 (Fixed Income Analysis), one section of FINC 489 (Quantitative Research Methods in Finance), and one section of FINC 688 (first-year PhD seminar).
- The design and materials for your courses are at the appropriate level of rigor, and the student evaluations are strong.

Service

- You served as a chair of two dissertation committees.
- You served on TAMU’s Diversity Fellowship Committee, TAMU’s Graduate Task Force, Mays’s AI Steering Committee, and the department’s PhD Program Executive Committee.

Tenured Faculty Assessment

As you will see below, the committee of professors unanimously rated your research performance as “excellent.” That said, the committee members are concerned that you are not converting the papers at the R&R stage into publications quickly enough. You were promoted to Associate Professor in 2016, and despite the large number of papers at the R&R stage, you have no publications in top Finance or Economics journals since then. To achieve eventual promotion to full professor, it will be necessary to push the R&Rs through to publications.

Your teaching performance continues to be excellent (unanimous), and we greatly appreciate your contributions in that area. Similarly, we also greatly appreciate your contributions in the service area. Given the comments above about research, we encourage you to think about how you could reallocate time from teaching and service to pushing your research papers through to publication.

Ratings (votes) from Full Professors

Research: Excellent (6)

Teaching: Excellent (6)

Service: Effective (6)

As a colleague: Excellent (6)

Overall: Excellent (6)

Department Head Assessment

I agree with the assessment and feedback from the Full Professors. Congratulations on the R&R at ReStud! You have a deep research pipeline and an impressive number of papers at later (R&R) stages at top journals, but it has been several years since you published a paper in a top finance journal. I echo the encouragement from the Full Professors to focus on converting these papers as soon as possible. Beyond the implications for promotion to Full Professor, quickly converting some of this work is important for you to maintain summer research funding and a three-course teaching load (the current policy at Mays requires two “A” publications over the prior 5-year period to keep summer funding and a three-course

teaching load). Thus, I strongly support your goal of finalizing some of these R&Rs in 2025, and I hope you will let me know if there is anything the department can do to help you reach those goals!

Thank you for your dedication to teaching, particularly the effort you put into developing the new flex online course for the MBA program. I also appreciate your extensive involvement in department and college service, most notably your work with PhD students and service on the new college-level AI steering committee. I do agree with recommendation from the Full Professors, however, that you try to reallocate some of your time from teaching and service to your research program.

Thank you very much for your contributions to the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance and Mays Business School. It is a pleasure to work with you!

Please acknowledge receipt of this evaluation by signing below. Note that your signature does not indicate your agreement with the contents of this evaluation.

Hwagyun Kim
Hwagyun Kim (May 29, 2025 11:30 CDT)
Hwagyun Kim

05/29/2025
Date

Kim 2024 Annual Review

Final Audit Report

2025-05-29

Created:	2025-05-29 (Central Daylight Time)
By:	Lauren Gray (laurenggray@tamu.edu)
Status:	Signed
Transaction ID:	CBJCHBCAABAAz_hHk68ya7lhvxLK9WdiHqv_x3exY9dO
Documents:	Kim 2024 Annual Review .docx (3 pages)
Number of Documents:	1
Document page count:	3
Number of supporting files:	0
Supporting files page count:	0

"Kim 2024 Annual Review" History

-  Document created by Lauren Gray (laurenggray@tamu.edu)
2025-05-29 - 10:34:27 AM CDT
-  Document emailed to Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu) for signature
2025-05-29 - 10:35:05 AM CDT
-  Email viewed by Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu)
2025-05-29 - 11:19:09 AM CDT
-  Agreement viewed by Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu)
2025-05-29 - 11:19:11 AM CDT
-  Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu) authenticated with Adobe Acrobat Sign.
2025-05-29 - 11:19:49 AM CDT
-  Document e-signed by Jamie Brown (jrbrown@tamu.edu)
Signature Date: 2025-05-29 - 11:19:49 AM CDT - Time Source: server
-  Document emailed to Hwagyun Kim (hagenkim@tamu.edu) for signature
2025-05-29 - 11:19:52 AM CDT
-  Email viewed by Hwagyun Kim (hagenkim@tamu.edu)
2025-05-29 - 11:27:50 AM CDT
-  Agreement viewed by Hwagyun Kim (hagenkim@tamu.edu)
2025-05-29 - 11:28:16 AM CDT

 Document e-signed by Hwagyun Kim (hagenkim@tamu.edu)

Signature Date: 2025-05-29 - 11:30:37 AM CDT - Time Source: server

 Agreement completed.

2025-05-29 - 11:30:37 AM CDT